

General Problem – On Occupational Stress

Specific Problem – To compare levels of occupational stress between 2 private sector and 2 government sector employees

Basic Concept – The concept of occupational stress has developed through various theoretical perspectives over time. It stems from the broader construct of *stress*, which refers to the physiological and psychological responses triggered when an individual's ability to cope is exceeded (Colligan & Higgins, 2005). Early definitions considered stress either as a **stimulus** (external pressures causing strain) or a **response** (individual reactions to these pressures). Selye (1974) defined stress as “the non-specific response of the body to any demand,” and introduced the distinction between *eustress* (positive stress) and *distress* (negative stress).

Later, the **transactional model** of stress by Lazarus and Folkman (1984) emphasized the interaction between the person and their environment. This model focused on how individuals appraise stressful situations (primary appraisal) and assess their ability to cope (secondary appraisal), making stress a subjective and dynamic process. In today's world, factors such as globalization, rapid technological changes, and organizational restructuring have made work environments more demanding and unpredictable (Michie, 2002). As a result, occupational stress is now understood as a multidimensional and evolving concept that requires both individual-level and organizational-level approaches to manage effectively.

Stress may be defined as the physiological or psychological response to internal or external stressors (APA). Stress involves changes affecting nearly every system of the body, influencing how people feel and behave. For example, it may be manifested by palpitations, sweating, dry mouth, shortness of breath, fidgeting, accelerated speech, augmentation of negative emotions (if already being experienced), and longer duration of stress fatigue.

Occupational Stress refers to a physiological and psychological response to events or conditions in the workplace that is detrimental to health and well-being. It is influenced by such factors as autonomy and independence, decision latitude, workload, level of responsibility, job security, physical environment and safety, the nature and pace of work, and relationships with coworkers and supervisors.

TYPES OF STRESS-

The different types of stress are stated as follows:

Acute Stress: Acute stress is the type of stress that has an effect upon the mental balance of the individuals. This is the type of stress that comes in a rapid way and often expectedly.

Episodic Acute Stress: Episodic acute stress is the type of stress that has an effect upon the mental balance of the individuals. This is the type of stress that comes in a rapid way and often expectedly.

Chronic Stress: Chronic stress is the type of stress that tends to occur among individuals on a regular basis throughout their lives. This type of stress will have unfavourable effects upon the physical and psychological health conditions of the individuals. Furthermore, they may feel burnout as well. The major effect of chronic stress is upon the physical and psychological

health conditions of the individuals.

Emotional Stress: Emotional stress can be more severe and painful as compared to other types of stress (Freshwater, 2018). When the work pressure is too much within the workplace or the individuals experience strenuous terms and relationships with other individuals, i.e. family members, relatives, friends, colleagues, supervisors, employers or other individuals, they experience emotional stress. When this stress is experienced in a major form, it has adverse effects upon the physical and psychological health conditions of the individuals.

Physical Stress: Physical stress is the stress that has effects upon the physical health conditions of the individuals. There are numerous causes of physical stress, i.e. various types of health problems and illnesses, wounds, injuries, infections, toxins, inadequate light, lack of electricity, fatigue, inadequate oxygen supply, deficiencies of essential nutrients, food allergies and sensitivities, unhealthy eating habits, dehydration, substance abuse, dental challenges, and musculoskeletal misalignments and imbalances.

Eustress: Eustress is referred to as beneficial stress. In other words, it is good stress. Eustress produces positive feelings of excitement. When the individuals feel happy to a major due to some factors, they feel eustress. One of the major benefits of this type of stress is, the individuals develop motivation towards the implementation of job duties.

SOURCES OF STRESS

Stress can come from a wide range of sources, often called **stressors**. These can be internal (from within yourself) or external (from the environment). Below are the major sources of stress, grouped into key categories:

1. Personal or Internal Sources of Stress

- **Negative thoughts:** Constant self-criticism or pessimism.
- **Perfectionism:** Setting unrealistically high standards.
- **Health issues:** Chronic illness, sleep problems, or poor nutrition.
- **Lack of control:** Feeling powerless or stuck in a situation.
- **Fear and uncertainty:** Worrying about the future or the unknown.

2. Work or Academic-Related Stress

- **Workload:** Too much to do, tight deadlines, or unrealistic expectations.
- **Job insecurity:** Fear of losing your job or lack of career progression.
- **Workplace conflicts:** Difficult relationships with colleagues or bosses.
- **Academic pressure:** Exams, assignments, grades, and future career concerns.
- **Lack of work-life balance:** Difficulty separating work from personal life.

3. Social and Relationship Stress

- **Family issues:** Conflict, divorce, or family illness.
- **Romantic relationship problems:** Breakups, lack of trust, or emotional distance.

- **Peer pressure:** Especially common in adolescents or social groups.
- **Loneliness or social isolation:** Lack of emotional support.

4. Financial Stress

- **Debt:** Credit card bills, loans, or mortgages.
- **Unemployment or underemployment:** Not earning enough to meet needs.
- **Unexpected expenses:** Medical bills, car repairs, etc.

5. Life Changes and Transitions

- **Moving:** Changing homes or cities.
- **Starting or losing a job:** Big adjustments in daily life.
- **Marriage, divorce, or having children:** Even positive changes can be stressful.
- **Loss of a loved one:** Grief and emotional adjustment.

6. Environmental Stressors

- **Noise, pollution, or overcrowding:** Especially in urban settings.
- **Climate and weather:** Extreme heat, cold, or natural disasters.
- **Unsafe or unstable environments:** Crime, war, or political unrest.

7. Technology and Information Overload

- **Constant notifications and screen time:** Lack of downtime.
- **Social media:** Comparison, FOMO (fear of missing out), or online harassment.
- **Work demands through technology:** Being "always connected" to work.

Sources of Occupational Stress:

i) **Work Overload:** Excessive workload and unrealistic deadlines often lead to stress, burnout, and poor job satisfaction. When employees are consistently expected to work more in a short span of time, it can create chronic stress.

ii) **Lack of Job Clarity:** Uncertainty about job responsibilities or expectations can lead to confusion, anxiety, and stress. Moreover, role ambiguity and role conflict are both strong predictors of occupational stress (Rizzo, House, & Lirtzman, 1970).

iii) **Lack of Control and Autonomy:** Employees who feel they have little control over their work or decision-making processes are more likely to experience stress. Moreover, this feeling may result in fear of job loss or organizational changes (e.g., downsizing, mergers) can lead to prolonged stress and decreased job engagement (Karasek, 1979).

iv) Poor Interpersonal skills and worklife balance: Conflict with coworkers or supervisors, lack of social support, and workplace bullying or harassment are prominent contributors to occupational stress. Moreover, studies have shown that difficulty in balancing professional responsibilities with personal life for a long time can cause significant stress and impact overall well-being (Greenhaus & Beutell, 1985).

v) Unfavourable working conditions: Researches have shown that exposure to loud noise, overcrowding, poor lighting, and hazardous environments can create physical and psychological stress within an individual (Evans & Johnson, 2000).

Hazards of Occupational Stress:

i) Physical and Mental Health Problems: Long-term exposure to occupational stress can have serious physical effects on an individual's overall health and well-being. Employees experiencing constant stress are more vulnerable to heart problems, such as high blood pressure and coronary artery disease. They may also experience frequent headaches, fatigue, muscle tension, or gastrointestinal issues like ulcers or indigestion. Chronic stress can in turn weaken the immune system, making individuals more susceptible to illness and infections (Kivimäki et al., 2006). Moreover, occupational stress significantly affects mental well-being as well. Individuals experiencing high levels of job stress may suffer from anxiety, irritability, mood swings, and in more severe cases, depression. Over time, unresolved stress can also lead to emotional exhaustion, low self-esteem, and in some cases, dependence on substances like alcohol or medication to cope with daily pressures (Melchior et al., 2007).

ii) Burnout Syndrome: One of the most common consequences of prolonged exposure to occupational stress is burnout. This condition is marked by emotional exhaustion, cynicism or detachment from work, and a reduced sense of personal accomplishment. Employees with burnout often feel drained, helpless, and demotivated. They may also start withdrawing from social or work-related interactions, affecting overall productivity and team cohesion (Maslach & Leiter, 1997).

iii) Increased Absenteeism and Presenteeism: Employees experiencing occupational stress often resort to taking frequent sick leaves to cope with physical or mental fatigue. At the same time, some employees might continue coming to work despite being unwell—this is known as presenteeism. In both cases, the organization suffers, as there is either a lack of productivity or the presence of underperforming workers.

iv) Impaired Personal Relationships: Work-related stress often casts an impact over an individual's personal life, causing strain in family and social relationships. One may become irritable, withdrawn, or emotionally unavailable, leading to conflicts at home or with colleagues. Poor communication and lack of support at the workplace further intensify stress, creating a cycle of interpersonal tension.

v) Decreased Job Performance and Work Productivity: Stress has a direct negative impact on cognitive functions such as attention, memory, and decision-making. Employees facing this constant stress are more prone to making errors, missing deadlines, and struggling with time management. Over time, their motivation and efficiency decline, affecting overall output and the quality of work delivered.

vi) Low Job Satisfaction and High Turnovers: A stressful work environment can lead to decreased job satisfaction, making employees feel unappreciated, overburdened, or disengaged. When workers feel that their well-being is not valued, they are more likely to consider quitting. This contributes to high turnover rates, which also create disruptions in team functioning and increase recruitment costs (Avey, Luthans, & Jensen, 2009).

Intervention Techniques to tackle Occupational Stress:

i) Time Management Training: Effective time management reduces feelings of being overwhelmed and overburdened by tasks. Training employees on how to plan, prioritize tasks, and allocate time wisely allows them to manage workloads efficiently. This leads to better productivity and a greater sense of control over their responsibilities, thereby reducing occupational stress.

ii) Cognitive Behavioural Techniques (CBT): Cognitive Behavioural Therapy helps an individual to identify their irrational beliefs and negative thought patterns that contribute to stress. This is done by identifying various negative thinking patterns and developing healthier cognitive and behavioral skills. CBT in the workplace focuses on improving employee well-being, behavioral change, and performance by addressing issues like stress, anxiety, and depression. Thus this leads to an increased level of self-esteem, better performance, and improved overall mental health. Organizations must integrate CBT principles into their wellness programs to support employees (Richardson & Rothstein, 2008).

iii) Job Redesign and Workload Management: Organizations can seek to reduce job related stress of their employees by modifying their job roles to ensure clarity, manageable workloads, and autonomy. Redesigning work to include task variety, skill use, and appropriate demands helps prevent burnout and makes work more meaningful. Studies have shown that job redesign can improve overall well-being of their employees and as a result their work productivity increases which is beneficial to any organization's success in the long run (Greenhaus & Powell, 2006).

iv) Employee Assistance Programs (EAPs): These programs provide employees with confidential access to professional counselors and support services. These programs help address both personal and workplace issues like mental health challenges, financial concerns, or interpersonal problems, thereby improving overall well-being and job satisfaction.

v) Social Support and Team Building: Every organization has their unique set of philosophy and work culture catering to their beliefs and values. Thus, creating a culture where employees feel supported by peers and their supervisors helps reduce emotional strain. Team-building exercises and peer support groups foster connection, cooperation, and a sense of belonging, which buffer against occupational stress.

vi) Leadership Training for Managers: Managers who are trained in recognizing stress, showing empathy, and providing constructive feedback are better equipped to support their teams. In today's world emotional intelligence is given equal significance and importance like our general intelligence or knowledge about the task. Emotional intelligent leadership skills creates a psychologically safe working environment for the employees and minimizes sources of stress before they can even escalate (Kelloway & Barling, 2010).

Although occupational stress is a significant challenge in today's work environments, it can be effectively managed through a combination of individual and organizational interventions. Mindfulness practices such as meditation, yoga, deep breathing, or progressive muscle relaxation help individuals stay grounded and present. Moreover, encouraging flexible working hours and providing adequate leave supports employees in managing both their personal and professional lives. Maintaining this balance helps prevent chronic stress, improves morale, and increases employee engagement.

Review of Literature:

International study:

Occupational stress has long been a subject of research, examined through the lenses of gender, age, economic status, job roles, and workplace conditions. Across decades, scholars have sought to untangle not only what causes workplace stress but also how it manifests across different groups and contexts. While the factors may shift from one setting to another, the underlying question has remained the same: why do some people thrive under work pressure while others struggle, and what can be done to help?

A recent investigation by Yitagesu Habtu and colleagues (2025) shines a spotlight on one of the most vital yet overburdened groups—health workers. In a cross-sectional study involving 1,426 professionals from nine public hospitals in Central and Southern Ethiopia, the team used tools such as the Perceived Occupational Stress Scale, the Occupational Depression Inventory, and the Job Anxiety Scale to explore how psychosocial factors shape occupational stress, depression, and job anxiety. The results painted a clear picture: lower social support, fewer job rewards, heavier job demands, and greater work–family conflict all amplified stress. Social support, however, acted as a partial buffer, softening the mental health impact even in high-pressure environments. The message was both urgent and actionable—workplace strategies that boost social support, recognition, and rewards, while promoting a healthier work–life balance, could significantly ease the burden on health professionals.

Though Habtu et al.'s study captures a modern view of occupational stress, the interest in how personal variables influence it is far from new. Decades earlier, James A. Grosch and Michael P. Morrison (1998) took a meta-analytic approach, pooling findings from 26 independent studies conducted between 1968 and 1997 to examine age-related patterns. Their results revealed a slight but consistent negative correlation between age and work stress ($r = -0.06$), suggesting that older workers tended to experience less stress than younger ones. More notably, job satisfaction tended to rise with age, while role ambiguity and role conflict declined—likely reflecting the clarity, confidence, and coping skills that come with experience.

Meanwhile, in a very different professional sphere, Adebisi (2013) turned attention to the everyday reality of academics in southwest Nigeria. Armed with the Occupational Stress Index (Srivastava & Singh, 1981), the study traced stress to sources such as role overload, unclear responsibilities, and the unrelenting demands of teaching, research, and administration. While some faculties bore a heavier burden than others, the overall

pattern was clear: occupational pressures were tied to lower job satisfaction and poorer mental health. Importantly, by applying the OSI beyond its original cultural context, Adebisi demonstrated its versatility as a diagnostic tool for identifying stress hotspots in higher education, paving the way for targeted interventions.

Together, these studies—spanning hospitals, corporate offices, and university campuses—underscore a common truth: while the faces and settings may differ, occupational stress is shaped by a mix of structural pressures and personal factors. Addressing it requires not only understanding the sources but also implementing context-specific strategies that empower workers, clarify roles, and strengthen the support systems around them.

Indian study:

One morning in 2003, Chaudhury stepped into a string of bustling bank branches across India—some belonging to the steady, tradition-bound public sector, others to the sleek, fast-paced private sector. Clipboard in hand, he carried the Organizational Stress Index (Shrivastava & Singh, 1981), determined to chart the invisible weight employees carried on their shoulders. As the responses rolled in, two distinct pictures emerged. In the public sector, stress seeped in through the cracks of role overload, role ambiguity, and the heavy responsibility of managing others' work. In the private sector, the strain came less from unclear duties and more from a feeling of powerlessness—being shut out of key decisions. Then came the gender lens: women reported the sting of strained peer relationships and the frustration of low status at work. By the end of his rounds, Chaudhury held more than just data—he held stories of workplace strain unique to each sector, proof that the OSI could capture pressures in a way that truly reflected the Indian workplace reality.

Fast-forward to recent years, and the issue of workplace stress had only deepened, stretching far beyond banking halls. In West Bengal, Bandyopadhyay and Dutta (2025) walked into university corridors and faculty offices, aiming to understand how organizational role stress shapes the quality of work life for academics. Surveying 303 faculty members using the Organizational Role Stress Scale (ORSS), they found three main culprits: role overload, stagnation, and resource inadequacy. Private university faculty, along with women, reported higher stress levels, and the consequences were tangible—reduced job satisfaction and poorer work–life quality. Their conclusion was unambiguous: institutional reforms were urgently needed to ease these burdens and protect the well-being of academic staff.

The same theme echoed in Sharma's (2023) work within India's Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs). Using a mixed-method approach of interviews and surveys with 218 employees, Sharma developed and validated a tool to measure occupational stress, uncovering five dominant stressors: rapid technological change, austerity measures, a culture of blame, multitasking demands, and work–life imbalance. These factors, Sharma found, extracted a heavy toll on employee well-being, revealing the need for targeted stress management strategies and more humane HR policies.

From Chaudhury's early observations in bank branches to Bandyopadhyay and Dutta's university hallways and Sharma's PSU offices, the thread is clear: across sectors, roles, and decades, occupational stress in India is not a

silent burden—it is a structural challenge. And unless organizations confront it with thoughtful, systemic change, the toll on job satisfaction, mental health, and quality of life will only grow heavier.

Plan of the Study: This study aims to compare levels of occupational stress between private sector and government sector employees using the Occupational Stress Index (OSI). The following outlines the methodological framework of the study:

a) Research Design: The study adopts a comparative descriptive research design. This design is appropriate as it facilitates the comparison of occupational stress levels between two naturally occurring groups—employees from the private sector and those from the government sector—without any manipulation of variables. A between-group approach will be used to assess differences based on the employment sector.

b) Independent Variable (IV): The independent variable in this study is the type of employment sector, which has two categories:

- Private Sector
- Government Sector

Participants will be selected from each sector to allow a comparative analysis.

c) Dependent Variable (DV): The dependent variable is the level of occupational stress, which will be measured using the standardized Occupational Stress Index (OSI) developed by Srivastava and Singh (1984). The OSI is a widely validated tool that quantifies various dimensions of job-related stress, providing a comprehensive score indicating overall occupational stress.

d) Extraneous Variables (EV): Several extraneous variables could influence occupational stress but are not the central focus of the study. These include:

- **Age - By keeping a age range(eg. 25 years to 40 years)**
- **Gender - Only on Male Population**
- **Years of Work Experience - categorization based on years of work experience**
- **Job Role or Designation - Equal No. of participants from both Private and Public sector**
- **Educational Qualification - Minimum degree required Bachelors & maximum Masters**
- **Working Hours - By keeping multiple range of working hours while data collecting (eg. 6-8hr ; 8-10hrs, ect)**
- **Marital Status - Preferably Single/Unmarried**

To control for these variables and reduce their potential confounding effect, the following strategies will be adopted:

- Ensuring demographic matching across groups where possible
- Using inclusion/exclusion criteria during sample selection

- Applying statistical controls (e.g., ANCOVA) during data analysis if necessary

B. METHODOLOGY:

1. Preliminaries:

Name of the participant:

Age of the participant:

Gender:

Condition:

Date of testing:

Time of testing:

2. Materials Required:

- **Occupational Stress Index (OSI) Questionnaire:** Standardized test booklet containing 46 items (statements).
- **Answer Sheet / Response Sheet:** For participants to mark their responses (typically a 5-point Likert scale: SD, D, N, A, SA).
- **Scoring Key / Manual:** Official key to convert responses into numerical scores and interpret stress levels.
- **Pencil / Pen:** For participants to fill in their responses.
- **Stopwatch / Clock:** To record the time taken for completion (optional, for uniform administration).
- **Consent Form:** To obtain informed consent from the participant.
- **Demographic Data Sheet:** To collect basic personal information (e.g., name, age, gender, occupation, experience).
- **Calculator:** For manual score calculation (if software is not used).
- **Table/Chair & Quiet Room:** A distraction-free environment for smooth test administration.

(For Online Mode)

- **Google Form (Digital OSI Questionnaire):** Includes all 46 OSI items with Likert scale options.
- **Scoring Sheet / Excel Sheet** (For the researcher, to analyze responses after collection)
- **Device (Phone, Tablet, or Computer):** To access and fill out the form.
- **Internet Connection:** For real-time form submission.

3. Description of the Test: The **Occupational Stress Index** purports to measure the extent of stress which employees perceive arising from various constituents and conditions of their job. However, stress researchers

have developed the scales which measure the stress arising exclusively from job roles (Rizzo et al., 1970; Pareek, 1981).

The tool may conveniently be administered to employees of every level operating in the context of industries or other non-production organizations. However, it would prove more suitable for the employees of supervisory level and above.

The scale consists of 46 items, each to be rated on a five-point scale. Out of 46 items, 28 are 'true-keyed' and the remaining 18 are 'false-keyed'. The items are related to almost all relevant components of job life which cause stress in one way or another, such as: Role overload, Role ambiguity, Role conflict, Group and political pressures. Responsibility for persons, Under-participation, Powerlessness, Poor peer relations, Intrinsic impoverishment, Low status, Strenuous working conditions, and Unprofitability.

The following Table gives an account of the items constituting various subscales of the O. S. I. along with their indices of internal consistency.

Sr. No	Subscales (Occupational Stressors)	Item Numbers	Range of r_{pis}
1	Role Overload	1, 13, 25, 36, 44, 46	.30 – .46
2	Role Ambiguity	2, 14*, 26, 37	.20 – .48
3	Role Conflict	3, 15*, 27, 38*, 45	.36 – .53
4	Unreasonable Group & Political Pressures	4, 16, 28, 39	.21 – .52
5	Responsibility for Persons	5, 17, 29	.30 – .57
6	Under Participation	6*, 18*, 30*, 40*	.55 – .73
7	Powerlessness	7*, 19*, 31*	.44 – .62
8	Poor Peer Relations	8*, 20, 32*, 41*	.24 – .49
9	Intrinsic Impoverishment	9, 21*, 33*, 42	.32 – .64
10	Low Status	10*, 22*, 34	.48 – .63
11	Strenuous Working Conditions	12, 24, 35, 43*	.40 – .63
12	Unprofitability	11, 23	.48 – .51

4. Instructions: “Welcome, and thank you for taking the time to participate in this assessment. Before we begin, please **take a moment to sit comfortably and relax**. This questionnaire is part of a psychological assessment

and is intended to gather information about your perceptions, feelings, and experiences related to your job. Your responses will help in understanding various components of job attitudes and workplace behaviour.”

You will find a series of statements in this questionnaire. For each statement, please indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree by selecting **one** of the five response options listed below:

- **SD** – Strongly Disagree
- **D** – Disagree
- **N** – Neutral
- **A** – Agree
- **SA** – Strongly Agree

Example: If you strongly agree with the statement:

"I have to do such work as ought to be done by others."

Then you would mark **SA**.

If you strongly disagree with the same statement, you would mark **SD**, and so on.

“Please answer **honestly and thoughtfully**, based on your own job experience. Your responses are strictly confidential and will be used only for academic, research, or professional assessment purposes. If you have any questions at any point, please feel free to ask.”

5. Procedure:

Welcoming the Participant: Greet the participant warmly and ask them to be seated comfortably. Briefly explain the purpose of the assessment and assure them that their responses will be kept strictly confidential.

Clarifying the Task: Inform the participant that they will be responding to a series of statements related to their job or work environment. Emphasize that there are no right or wrong answers, and encourage them to answer honestly based on their own experiences.

Providing the Questionnaire: Hand the questionnaire to the participant along with a pen or pencil. Reiterate the response scale:

- **SD** – Strongly Disagree
- **D** – Disagree
- **N** – Neutral
- **A** – Agree

SA – Strongly Agree

Make sure the participant understands how to mark their responses clearly.

Ensuring a Comfortable Environment: Allow the participant to complete the questionnaire at their own pace in a quiet and distraction-free setting. Offer water if appropriate and ensure they are physically comfortable.

Completion and Collection: Once the participant finishes, thank them for their time and collect the completed questionnaire. Ask if they have any questions or feedback about the process.

Debriefing (if applicable): If the procedure includes a debrief, briefly discuss the next steps or clarify how their responses will be used. Reassure them of the confidentiality of their data.

6. **Scoring:** Since the questionnaire consists of both **true-keyed** and **false-keyed** items, two different patterns of scoring have to be adopted for the two types of items. The following table provides a guideline to score the responses given to two categories of items:

Categories of response	Scores – True-keyed Items	Scores – False-keyed Items
Never / Strongly disagree	1	5
Seldom / Disagree	2	4
Sometimes / Undecided	3	3
Mostly / Agree	4	2
Always / Strongly agree	5	1

7. **Norms:** Norms have been prepared for the scores on Occupational Stress Index as a whole as well as for its twelve sub-scales separately on a representative sample of 700 employees of different cadres operating in various production and non-production organizations. The distribution of scores on the O.S.I. was found to be slightly skewed in negative direction. To prepare the norms three methods were adopted i.e., normal distribution, percentile point and division of upper and lower halves.

Norms Table 1 represents the levels of occupational stress along with the item numbers the sample will fall in.

Sub-Scale	Low ($< -1\sigma$)	Moderate ($\pm 1\sigma$)	High ($> +1\sigma$)
I	6–14	15–22	23–30
II	4–9	10–12	13–20

III	5–12	13–17	18–25
IV	4–9	10–14	15–20
V	3–7	8–11	12–15
VI	4–9	10–12	13–20
VII	3–7	8–11	12–15
VIII	4–8	9–13	14–20
IX	4–9	10–13	14–20
X	3–6	7–11	12–15
XI	4–9	10–12	13–20
XII	2–4	5–7	8–10
Total Score	46–122	123–155	156–230

The scores have been categorized as to indicate high, moderate and low levels of Occupational stress also on the basis of its percentile values. The scores below P25, between P26 and P75 and above P75 were taken as to indicate low, moderate and high levels of occupational stress, respectively. The following Table records the prepared norms.

Norms Table 2 represents the percentile value of the occupational stress along with the item numbers the sample will fall in.

Sub-Scales	Low ($P_{(25)}$ & below)	Moderate ($P_{26} - P_{75}$)	High (Above P_{75})
I	6 – 17	18 – 22	23 – 30
II	4 – 10	11 – 14	15 – 20
III	5 – 13	14 – 17	18 – 25
IV	4 – 10	11 – 14	15 – 20
V	3 – 8	9 – 12	13 – 15
VI	4 – 10	11 – 13	14 – 20
VII	3 – 8	9 – 11	12 – 25

VIII	4 – 9	10 – 13	14 – 20
IX	4 – 10	11 – 13	14 – 20
X	3 – 7	8 – 11	12 – 15
XI	4 – 10	11 – 14	15 – 20
XII	2 – 5	6 – 8	9 – 10
Scale as a whole	46 – 127	128 – 150	151 – 230

The scores were also divided into upper and lower halves on the basis of the median point of the distribution of the stress scores. The score below median and above median were categorized, respectively as to indicate low and high levels of occupational stress. The following table provides the norms on this criterion

Norms Table 3 represents the upper and lower halves on the basis of the median point of the stress scores of the samples.

Sub-Scales	High (Above Median)	Low (Below Median)
I	6 – 19	20 – 30
II	4 – 12	13 – 20
III	5 – 15	16 – 25
IV	4 – 12	13 – 20
V	3 – 10	11 – 15
VI	4 – 12	13 – 20
VII	3 – 9	10 – 15
VIII	4 – 11	12 – 20
IX	4 – 11	12 – 20
X	3 – 9	10 – 15
XI	4 – 12	13 – 20
XII	2 – 6	7 – 10
Scale as a whole	46 – 129	140 – 230

8. Reliability: The reliability index ascertained by split-half (odd-even) method and Cronbach's alpha-coefficient for the scale as a whole were found to be **.935** and **.90**, respectively. The reliability indices of the 12 sub-scales were also computed through the split-half method. The following table records the obtained indices of reliability:

Sr. No	Sub Scales	Reliability Index
1	Role Overload	.684
2	Role Ambiguity	.554
3	Role Conflict	.696
4	Unreasonable Group & Political Pressures	.454
5	Responsibility for Persons	.840
6	Under Participation	.630
7	Powerlessness	.809
8	Poor Peer Relations	.549
9	Intrinsic Impoverishment	.556
10	Low Status	.789
11	Strenuous Working Conditions	.733
12	Unprofitability	.767

9. Validity: *Occupational Stress Index (O.S.I.)* was determined by computing coefficients of correlation between the scores on the O.S.I. and various measures of job attitudes and job behaviour. The employees' scores on the O.S.I. are likely to positively correlate with the scores on the measures of such role-related attitudinal, motivational, and personality variables which have proved effective in lowering or moderating the level of occupational stress. The coefficients of correlation between the scores on the O.S.I. and the measures of **Job Involvement** (Lodhal & Kejner, 1965), and **Work Motivation** (Srivastava, 1980) Ego-strength (Hasan, 1970), and Job satisfaction (Pestonjee, 1973) were found to be .56 (N=225), .44 (N=200), -.40 (N=205) and -.51 (N=500), respectively. The correlation between the scores on the O.S.I. and the measure of Job Anxiety (Srivastava, 1974) was found to be .59 (N=400).

The employee's score on O.S.I. have been found to be positively correlated with their score on the measures of Mental (ill) Health, standardized by Dr. O. N. Srivastava (Prof. of Psychiatry). The following table presents the indices of mental (ill) health of high and low occupational stress group of the employees:

Sr. No	Symptoms of Mental Ill Health	High Stress Group (N = 103)		Low Stress Group (N = 97)		C.R .
		Mean	S.D.	Mean	S.D.	
1	Free floating anxiety	6.17	3.46	4.12	3.55	4.1*
2	Obsessive traits & symptoms	7.86	3.09	7.69	3.24	0.47
3	Phobic anxiety	6.13	3.62	4.43	3.15	3.54**
4	Somatic complaints	6.50	3.77	4.35	3.39	4.23**
5	Neurotic depression	5.35	3.30	4.29	3.60	4.90**
6	Hysterical neurosis	5.24	2.88	4.44	2.78	2.00*

Results

Interpretation

Conclusion

Reference (APA 7th edition):

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